

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The Importance of a Document with Detailed Information



Learning Outcome:

Designs a user manual that fulfills both the IT solution needs and the client requirements.

Understand how to write a good user manual.

Ask your partner:

- When you buy a product, do you read the documents that come with it inside the box? Why? Why not?
- If you had to write a guide for someone to learn how to use something, what steps would you include?

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about past experiences with user manuals.
- I can describe how to improve a user manual.
- I can talk about the importance of having good user manuals.





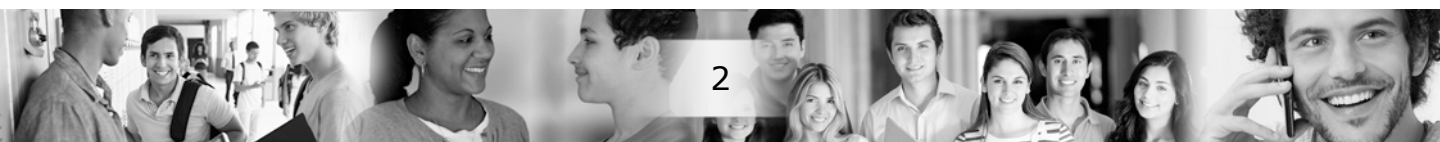
Let's Explore!

Sarah and Chris are assembling a computer they just bought.



Instructions: Read the text below.

- Sarah:** I don't know where to plug in this cable. Can you please check the manual?
Chris: Let me see. I wish this user manual was clearer, it doesn't seem to be very user-friendly.
- Sarah:** I know! I remember the last time I bought a desktop, it wasn't this hard. All the instructions, components, and pictures were very well designed, and we didn't have much trouble putting the parts together. That desktop computer company worked really hard to help users get familiar with their products.
- Chris:** What were you told by the clerk?
Sarah: He said I should find everything in the manual. I wish I knew more about computers, but I'm not a big fan of electronics.
- Chris:** What else were you instructed to do?
Sarah: He didn't say much, actually.
- Chris:** I wish I could talk to the designers. I would suggest some tips, so users won't feel frustrated.
- Sarah:** What else would you suggest?
Chris: I would suggest including better pictures, and color ones if possible. I'd like to have clearer instructions. The ones in here are ignoring important steps and assuming we know how to do everything.
- Sarah:** I know, and the size of the manual doesn't feel right. Plus, the font size it uses is too small; there are words I can't even read.
- Chris:** It's a shame they don't see how important manuals are. We haven't started using this computer yet, and we are already having problems with it.
- Sarah:** I agree. From the very first time we saw the manual, we started interacting with the product somehow. A good user manual provides the customers with better experiences with the product. It teaches them new features and exploits at its maximum all the possibility.



**Let's Practice!**

What can you do to improve a user manual?

Instructions: Circle the correct word(s) to complete the text.

I have (been reading / be read / have read) many user manuals in order to see how they can be improved. I have (see / sees / seen) that most of them have clear instructions. However, there are some that need to be more specific. User manuals have been (help / helping / helped) many people to get familiar with the devices they purchase, but they (had / has / have) started to change. Nowadays, companies have (been / be / being) publishing user manual on their web pages instead of including them in the box of the products they sell. Unfortunately, some people have (have / had / having) issues obtaining user manuals online since they may not have access to the internet.

**Let's Practice!**

Is a user manual important for you?

Instructions: Circle the correct answer.

1. I wish designers _____ the importance of a user manual.
a. knew b. know c. known
2. I wish companies _____ that a manual is the first interaction the customer has with the product.
a. understand b. understood c. to understand
3. Designers wish they _____ a manual including everything the customer needs to know.
a. could draw b. could erase c. could create
4. Some people wish the manuals _____ more images to illustrate the instructions.
a. had b. have c. has
5. Mary wishes manuals _____ more helpful in making users get familiar with the products.
a. are b. was c. were
6. Many people wish that companies _____ the manuals in an easier way to be understood.
a. designed b. designs c. designing





Extension Activity

We need to know more about manuals.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for a manual that came with a device you, or anyone else bought.
- Read part of the manual whole manual and identify how it is organized.
- List the positive and negative things you found in that manual.
- Create a chart where you explain the positive things of that manual and how you would improve it.
- Share your chart with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I read a manual.
- I identify positive and negative characteristics in a manual.
- I list positive and negative characteristics in a manual.
- I create a chart where I explain the positive things of a manual and how I would improve it.
- I share my work with my class.

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Target Words

- clerk** (noun): the person who works in a store.
e.g. What were you told by the clerk?
- exploit** (verb): to make a productive use out of something.
e.g. It teaches them new features and exploits at its maximum all the possibility.
- instruct** (verb): to teach steps or instructions.
e.g. What else were you instructed to do?

- plug** (verb): to connect a cable in a device.
e.g. I don't know where to plug in this cable. Can you please check the manual?
- somehow** (adverb): in a nonspecific way.
e.g. From the very first time we saw the manual, we started interacting with the product somehow.



Learning Points

Wish + Past Form of Verb for Wishes

You can use the verb **wish** followed by a verb in **past** to talk about things you want.

We can use the verb **wish** to talk about events that we would like to happen in the present. As most of the things we wish for are imaginary, we use verbs in past. Take a look at the following structure:

Subject + **Wish** + Subject + **Verb in Past** + Complement

Example:

*I **wish** I **had** a user manual.*

*I **wish** these instructions **were** clearer.*

*Paul **wishes** he **knew** how to assemble the computer.*

Verb to be

As we use wish to talk about imaginary situations, we do not use the past form of the verb be **was**; we are going to use **were** regardless of the subject. However, in an informal context, you could use **was** if you want.

Example:

*I **wish** I **were** more skillful with computers.*

*She **wishes** she **were** a software engineer.*

Examples

- *I wish I knew more about computers, but I'm not a big fan of electronics.*
- *I wish I could talk to the designers. I would suggest some tips, so users won't feel frustrated.*

Simple Past Passive- Interrogative Form

You use **simple past passive** to provide more importance to the object and the action in a sentence rather than the subject.

When we use **passive voice** we focus on the object of the action rather than on the subject. The subject can be mention or omitted and the sentence should keep the same intention. If you want to mention the subject, you use **by** after the verb. To create questions, this is the grammatical structure that you need to follow:

Verb to be in past + Object of the Sentence + **Verb in Past Participle** + Complement +?

Example:

***Were** those computers **designed** to support any kind of file?*

*Who **were** those manuals **written** for?*

Examples

- *What were you told by the clerk?*
- *What else were you instructed to do?*

